be assessed on merit. If they exhibit winning potential, then they will be given tickets. Elections, ultimately, are fought to be won. They are not a mere formality to go through.

Q. People say that the law and order situation in the state has improved under your watch. What is the Yogi Model of law and order?
The Yogi Model is one that does not hesitate to display pictures of trouble-makers in public squares, one that decrees that if you burn public property, then you will make good the loss too; one that ensures that if you hassle innocent people, then the police will chase you down; one that ensures your empire will be bulldozed if you have encroached upon public property, the property of the poor or of businessmen.

Q. Does it include giving the police a 'free hand' to gun down criminals if needed?
To establish 'good governance', we have given freedom to the administrative machinery in the state. They have been given an opportunity to work freely under the law without any political intervention. And it is the main reason for our success in the state. The National Crime Records Bureau data will tell you the story, it is all online.

Q. But this is being attributed to non-reporting of crimes in UP, of cases not being registered.
That doesn't happen anymore. It used to happen when the systems were physical. These days, everything is online. The state has 1,535 police stations where you can get your FIR registered either digitally or online. There is no question of cases not being reported.

Q. Similar accusations were made regarding Covid deaths in the state. That a large number of deaths went unaccounted for, that bodies were cremated on the banks of the Ganga...
Whoever says this has to be the biggest scoundrel. The world has appreciated UP's Covid model. It is worthy of global emulation, and we have done so under the guidance of the prime minister. All our services—the number of tests, how many people have been admitted to hospitals, how many are in isolation—are reflected on our online portal. Anyone can see this information on the portal. Such misinformation is being spread by those who were power brokers earlier but have now been rendered jobless.

> **"Rather than give tickets to women to fight elections, we work towards empowering them. Our Mission Shakti programme is aimed towards their honour, safety and self-reliance"**

Q. Your government says your tenure has seen investments in excess of Rs 4 lakh crore. Are they just proposals as yet?
Projects worth Rs 4 lakh crore have been implemented on the ground. More than half of these units have already started production. We have given employment to 1.61 crore youth in the state. The reforms in UP along with the better law and order situation and sectoral policies have helped. In 2016, UP was in 14th place in the Ease of Doing Business rankings. It is now in second position. These achievements are the results of reforms. Thus UP is emerging as an industrial hub. The state is now among the top three investment destinations in the country.

Q. Would you call it 'Yoginomics'?
It's not Yoginomics but UP economics. It is not just investment, it is linked to employment.

Q. Unemployment is expected to be a big issue this election?
One should see the unemployment rate in Uttar Pradesh in 2015-16 and the unemployment rate as of date. CMIE (the Centre for Monitoring Indian Economy) data puts the current unemployment rate in UP at 4.9 per cent whereas it was 18 per cent in 2016-17.

Q. The menace of stray cattle seems to have become an election issue.
It is not an election issue. It is being raised by those who were involved in illegal slaughtering. We put an end to their illegal slaughtering and their smuggling of cattle. We have also come up with a *gauvansh* scheme to preserve cattle and incentivise farmers who participate in the scheme.

Q. If re-elected, what do you propose to do in the next five years?
We have already prepared the roadmap for the next five years. UP will become a trillion-dollar economy. Our committees are already working in that direction. One-trillion dollar economy means doubling the per capita income of the people in the state. It will bring joy in the life of the common man and raise their standard of living. The UP model will become an example for the rest of the country.

Q. In case you lose, will you continue in politics or return to being a Mahant again?
I have never accepted defeat and have never lost.

Q. What message would you want to give Akhilesh Yadav?
As the leader of a political party, Akhileshji has every right to fight an election. But he must be prepared for a massive defeat on March 10, 2022. ■